



The siege of Vicksburg

Union troops man their siege lines around impregnable Vicksburg. More than 200 Union guns pounded the city every day, while Porter's gunboats kept up a barrage from the river, until the inhabitants could take no more.

The Confederates try to fight back

At the end of June, under immense pressure from a frantic Jefferson Davis, Johnston feebly probed with his five divisions against Sherman, but with no result. A more serious attempt had been made in early June by General Richard Taylor, in command of Louisiana's Confederate forces. However, Taylor had even fewer troops than Johnston and was stopped cold at Milliken's Bend, a fortified Federal supply depot north of Vicksburg.

Among the defenders at Milliken's Bend were several regiments of freshly trained Black troops, Vicksburg being one of the first battles in which USCT regiments saw combat. They fought desperately against their attackers. Taylor's infuriated men shouted, "No quarter!" as they stormed forward. They succeeded in capturing